

OFFICIAL USER GUIDE & FEATURE OVERVIEW

Piano *Mastery* *Portal*

An AI-powered web application for learning any piano composition —
from upload to mastery in 30 days. Built by Brandon Rose.

ACCESS THE APP

piano-composition-mastery.manus.space

How *Piano Mastery* Was Created

Piano Mastery began with a single piece: **La Campanella** by Franz Liszt — one of the most technically demanding works in the entire piano repertoire. The goal was simple but ambitious: build a structured, intelligent framework for learning this piece from scratch in exactly 30 days.

Rather than relying on scattered YouTube tutorials or generic practice advice, the idea was to create a **complete study system** — one that analyzed the piece's technical demands, mapped them to the most relevant preparatory exercises (the Hanon 60), and produced a daily schedule with clear milestones and goals.



What started as a personal study guide quickly evolved into something far more powerful: a **universal AI-powered portal** that could do the same thing for any piano composition. Upload any score — a Chopin étude, a Beethoven sonata, a Bach invention — and the app reads it, understands it, and generates a complete personalized 30-day practice framework automatically.

"The best practice is not more practice — it is the right practice, at the right time, in the right order. This app is designed to give every pianist exactly that."

The app was built using a modern full-stack architecture: **React + TypeScript** on the frontend, **Express + tRPC** on the backend, a **MySQL database** for persistent storage, and **AI language models** for score analysis. The design follows a Nocturne — Dark Velvet Recital Hall aesthetic, with Playfair Display typography, antique gold accents, and the atmosphere of a candlelit 19th-century concert hall.

Technology Stack

FRONTEND

React 19 · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS 4 · Vite · pdfjs-dist · react-resizable-panels

BACKEND

Node.js · Express 4 · tRPC 11 · Drizzle ORM · MySQL · pdftotext

AI & DATA

LLM composition analysis · YouTube Data API · IMSLP
MediaWiki API · S3 file storage

AUTH & HOSTING

Manus OAuth · Per-user data isolation · Autoscale cloud
hosting · GitHub CI

LIVE APPLICATION

<https://piano-composition-mastery.manus.space>

SOURCE CODE

<https://github.com/BrandonRose2/piano-composition-mastery>

Piano Mastery Portal

How to *Use* the Portal

Piano Mastery is designed to be intuitive from the first visit. Here is a complete walkthrough of the core workflow from sign-in to your first day of practice.

1

Sign In

Visit piano-composition-mastery.manus.space and click **Sign in to begin**. Each user gets their own private account — your library and progress are completely isolated from other users.

2

Upload a Piano Score

Drag and drop any piano score PDF or image (PNG, JPG, WEBP) into the upload zone, or click **click to browse** to select a file. The app accepts scores from any source — IMSLP, purchased sheet music, or scanned pages.

3

AI Analysis Begins

The server extracts text from your PDF, identifies the composer and title, and sends the content to an AI model. Within 30–60 seconds, a complete analysis is generated covering technical demands, difficulty level, key signature and more.

4

Open Your Composition

Click the composition card in **Your Library** to open the full detail page. You will find five sections: Score Viewer, Historical Context, Technical Analysis, Hanon Exercises, and the 30-Day Practice Framework.

5

Set Your Start Date

In the 30-Day Framework section, click **Set start date** to choose your Day 1. Every day card will then display its corresponding calendar date, turning the tracker into a true scheduled 30-day plan.

6

Practice and Track Progress

Each day, open the day card to see your goals, expand it, and click the circle to mark it complete. Your progress is saved automatically and visible as a progress bar on the library card.

7

Use Split-Screen Mode

Click the **Split Screen** button in the composition header to open a full-screen practice view: your score on the left, the 30-day tracker on the right, with a draggable divider between them.

Piano Mastery Portal

Everything the *Portal* Can Do

AI Composition Analysis

Upload any piano score and the AI reads the actual content of the file — not just the filename. It identifies the composer, title, key, time signature, tempo markings, and technical characteristics, then generates a structured analysis covering five domains: historical context, technical demands, Hanon exercise mapping, and a full 30-day plan.

TECHNICAL ANALYSIS

Identifies the hardest passages, categorizes demands (leaps, trills, octaves, scales, repeated notes), and rates overall difficulty.

HANON EXERCISE MAPPING

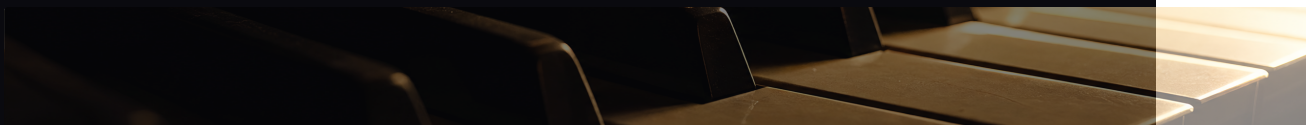
Maps up to 11 specific Hanon exercises directly to the piece's demands with explanations of why each one applies.

30-DAY FRAMEWORK

Generates a daily schedule with specific goals, tempo targets, and focus areas — structured across four progressive weeks.

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Provides composer biography, compositional history, performance tradition, and the cultural significance of the piece.



In-App Score Viewer

Every uploaded composition includes a built-in score viewer. PDFs are rendered page by page directly in the browser using pdfjs-dist. The toolbar provides page navigation, zoom controls (60%–300%), a download button, and a fullscreen mode. Image scores display with zoom and rotation controls.

Split-Screen Practice Mode

Activate split-screen from the composition header to open a full-screen overlay with the score on the left and the 30-day tracker on the right. A draggable gold divider lets you resize the panels freely. An Exit button returns you to the normal view.

Interactive 30-Day Tracker

The tracker includes a progress dashboard with an overall completion ring, a 30-cell day grid, per-week progress bars, and expandable day cards. Set a start date to display actual calendar dates on every card. Progress is saved to the database and synced across devices.

YouTube Integration

Every Hanon exercise row includes a **Watch** button that opens a YouTube search for that specific exercise tutorial. Each composition detail page also features an embedded performance video — the most-viewed professional recording of the piece, surfaced automatically.

Piano Mastery Portal

Sheet Music Search & *Library Tools*

Find Sheet Music — IMSLP Search

The **Find Music & Sheet Music** section on the home page lets you search the entire IMSLP catalog by composition name or composer. Results appear as cards with the piece title, composer, and a direct link to the IMSLP page where you can download the free PDF. An **Import to Library** button on each result opens a dialog where you paste the direct PDF URL and the app fetches, stores, and analyzes it automatically — no manual download required.

IMSLP hosts over 700,000 free public domain scores. Piano Mastery gives you direct access to this entire catalog from within the app.

Stream on Music Platforms

Switch to the **Stream** tab in the search section to find the piece on five major platforms. Each card opens a direct search on that service.

PLATFORM	BEST FOR
Spotify	Curated classical playlists, multiple recordings side by side
Apple Music	High-fidelity lossless audio, large classical catalog
YouTube Music	Live performances, masterclasses, and recital recordings
SoundCloud	Student recordings, practice recordings, rare interpretations
Tidal	HiFi/Master quality audio for critical listening

Library Management

Your library gives you full control over every composition you have added. Each card shows the title, composer, difficulty level, key, and a live progress bar reflecting your 30-day completion percentage.

RENAME COMPOSITIONS

Click any composition title in the library to edit it inline. Press Enter to save or Escape to cancel.

DELETE COMPOSITIONS

Hover over a card to reveal the trash icon. Click once to arm deletion, click again to confirm. All progress data is removed.

PROGRESS BARS

Each card shows a gold progress bar with the number of days completed out of 30 and the percentage.

FEATURED COMPOSITION

La Campanella by Franz Liszt is built in as a featured composition with the full pre-written analysis always available.

Per-User Privacy

Every account is fully isolated. Your compositions, uploads, progress data, and start dates are private to your account. Sharing the app link with friends gives them their own fresh, empty library — nothing is shared or combined.

Piano Mastery Portal

La Campanella

by Franz Liszt

La Campanella (S.141 No. 3) is the crown jewel of the Grandes Études de Paganini, composed in its definitive form in 1851. The title means "The Little Bell" in Italian, and the piece is built around a high, shimmering bell-like motif borrowed from the final movement of Paganini's Violin Concerto No. 2 in B minor.



Five Technical Challenges

CHALLENGE	LOCATION	WHY IT IS DIFFICULT
Large Leaps	Throughout; worst mm. 30–32	RH spans up to two octaves + a second within a sixteenth note
Repeated Notes	Opening and variation themes	Must ring like a bell; requires alternating fingers without tension
4–5 Finger Trills	mm. 80–83	Weakest fingers share a tendon; must sustain while voicing a melody
Chromatic Scales	mm. 73+	Must be feather-light and perfectly even at high speed
Octaves & Chords	Climax section	Requires wrist bounce endurance without locking up

Hanon Exercises for La Campanella

The app maps 11 specific Hanon exercises directly to the piece's demands. Key exercises include:

NO. 46 — TRILLS

Builds the 4th and 5th finger trill independence required at mm. 80–83.

NO. 44–45 — REPEATED NOTES

Trains the alternating finger technique for the bell-tone repeated note passages.

NO. 40 — CHROMATIC SCALES

Builds the even, feather-light chromatic scale technique required at mm. 73+.

NO. 53 — OCTAVE SCALES

Develops the wrist bounce and endurance needed for the climax octave passages.

NO. 31 & 6 — EXTENSIONS

Stretches the hand span to prepare for the large leap passages throughout.

NO. 39 & 41 — G# MINOR

Scales and arpeggios in the home key of the piece for tonal familiarity.

VIEW THE FULL LA CAMPANELLA STUDY
piano-composition-mastery.manus.space

Piano Mastery Portal

Tips, Shortcuts & *Best Practices*

Uploading Scores

For best AI analysis results, upload a text-based PDF (not a scanned image). Text-based PDFs allow the server to extract tempo markings, key signatures, and composer names directly. Scanned image PDFs still work — the AI uses the filename and its knowledge of the repertoire as a fallback.

SUPPORTED FILE TYPES

- PDF
- PNG
- JPG
- WEBP

Getting the Best Sheet Music

Use the **Find Sheet Music** search bar to search IMSLP directly from the app. For the highest quality scores, look for editions marked with 600dpi or 1200dpi resolution. The Busoni critical editions are recommended for scholarly reference; the Augener/Pauer editions are cleanest for daily practice use.

Practicing Effectively

WEEK	FOCUS	TEMPO TARGET
Week 1	Learn all sections hands-separately; map the score	50% of final tempo
Week 2	Hands together at reduced speed; prioritize accuracy	60% of final tempo
Week 3	Systematic metronome building; drill hardest passages	75–85% of final tempo
Week 4	Performance preparation; endurance runs; musical shaping	90–100% of final tempo

Using the Split-Screen

Split-screen is only available for compositions that have an uploaded score file. The button appears in the tag row of the composition header. Drag the gold divider left or right to give more space to the score or the tracker as needed.

Sharing the App

Share the link below with any pianist. Each person creates their own account and gets a completely fresh, private library. Feature updates you make to the app are instantly visible to all users — no reinstallation required.

SHARE THIS LINK

<https://piano-composition-mastery.manus.space>

Injury Prevention

Never practice through tension or pain. If your hand tightens, stop immediately, shake out, and resume at a slower tempo. The 30-day framework is designed with progressive loading — resist the temptation to skip ahead. Consistency at the right tempo is always more valuable than speed at the wrong one.

Piano Mastery Portal

PIANO MASTERY PORTAL

Begin Your *Journey*

Upload your first score, set your Day 1, and let the AI build your personalized path to mastery. Every great pianist started exactly where you are now.

START NOW

piano-composition-mastery.manus.space

SOURCE CODE

github.com/BrandonRose2/piano-composition-mastery